Business Architecture

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Business Architecture

Purpose of this chapter

The business architecture describes how a statistical organisation is organised to turn data into official statistics. It shows who is involved, which processes and functions they perform, which services they offer, what triggers their work, and which information they create and exchange.

The Strategy layer describes *what* the NSI must be able to do and *where* it creates value. The business architecture describes *how* that work is organised. It is the layer where capabilities and value streams become concrete: in roles that people take on, processes they carry out, and information they hand over to each other.

For official statistics, one question deserves special attention: where does responsibility for data pass from one part of the organisation to another? A statistical value chain is long. It involves many teams and often confidential data. An untraceable change or uncontrolled reuse at any point can undermine every statistic built on that data. The SAF business architecture therefore pays explicit attention to the points where data is stored, quality-assured and handed over. These handover points are the backbone of the reference models at the end of this chapter.

The business architecture is independent of technology. It does not describe applications or platforms. It does describe the business needs that applications and platforms must support, and it is the starting point for the data, application and technology architecture.

Position in the framework

The business architecture is the first of the core layers in TOGAF and ArchiMate (see *Position in the framework* in the Motivation chapter). In the TOGAF Architecture Development Method, it is developed in Phase B, Business Architecture. It receives direction from the Strategy layer and gives direction to the layers below it.

PLACEHOLDER: Position of the Business Architecture between the Strategy layer and the data, application and technology layers

Direction	Relationship	Example in the SAF
From Strategy	Business processes realise value stream stages	The execution processes of the Standardisation domain realise the stages of VS-02
From Strategy	Business functions and processes realise capabilities	The function *Classify Data* realises Data standardisation (1.3.1)
From Motivation	Principles and requirements shape the business design	SAF-P07 leads to loose coupling of domains through steady states
To Data Architecture	Business objects are realised by data objects	A registered *Raw Data* version is realised by a dataset in a data store
To Application Architecture	Business processes are served by application services	Data validation at intake is served by a validation service
To Technology Architecture	Business requirements drive platform requirements	Retention and versioning per steady state drive storage requirements

In TOGAF, Phase B produces a baseline and a target business architecture, and the gap between them. The SAF provides a reference for the target. An NSI describes its own baseline and uses the SAF to define where it wants to go.

How NSIs use this chapter

The SAF business architecture contains two kinds of content.

Reference content. Most NSIs perform the same statistical work and follow a comparable production process. The SAF therefore offers reference content for business processes, business functions, business services and business roles. NSIs use this content in the same three ways as the other SAF elements: adopt, adapt or extend.

Concepts with examples. Business events, business objects, contracts, representations and products are specific to each NSI. They depend on its products, its legal basis and its users. For these elements, the SAF explains the concept, how it is used, and gives examples. The toolkit provides templates.

The data value chain needs a separate choice. NSIs organise their chain in different ways, depending on their size, legal context and platforms. The SAF therefore offers more than one reference model for the chain: the Steady-State Architecture and the Medallion Architecture. An NSI chooses the model that fits, or combines them. This choice is a course of action in the sense of the Strategy chapter.

The business architecture is also the place where the NSI's own organisation meets the framework. An NSI maps its departments, teams and job profiles onto the SAF actors, roles and functions. The mapping shows which parts of the organisation carry which responsibilities, where they overlap, and where they are missing.

Toolkit (planned): Role mapping and RACI template; organisation-to-function mapping (see *Planned instruments* in the Toolkit)

Relationship with the statistical standards

The SAF business architecture builds on the statistical standards introduced in *Relationship with statistical standards* (Introduction). The SAF process model is based on GSBPM. GAMSO, which places GSBPM in the wider context of strategy and leadership, capability development and corporate support, is the frame of reference for the business functions; the functions are described in SAF terms, so that NSIs can apply them together with their own national function models. GSIM is the reference for the business objects.

Business architecture concepts in the SAF

The SAF uses the business layer elements of ArchiMate, and adds concepts that are specific to the statistical data value chain.

ArchiMate business elements used in the SAF

Concept	ArchiMate element	Question it answers	Example	SAF content
Business actor	Business Actor	Who is involved: a person, team or organisation?	Data provider, NSI, research institute	Reference
Business role	Business Role	Which responsibility does an actor take on?	Data owner, data steward, methodologist	Reference

Concept	ArchiMate element	Question it answers	Example	SAF content
Business collaboration	Business Collaboration	Which actors or roles work together?	A data sharing partnership between an NSI and a register holder	Reference
Business process	Business Process	Which sequence of activities produces a defined result?	Collect, Process, Disseminate	Reference
Business function	Business Function	What does the organisation do continuously, grouped by required knowledge and skills?	Manage Quality	Reference
Business service	Business Service	Which behaviour does the organisation offer to others?	Microdata access for researchers	Reference
Business interface	Business Interface	Through which channel is a service offered?	A web portal, a secure data transfer channel, a helpdesk	Reference
Business event	Business Event	What triggers a process, or marks its result?	*Raw Data Registered*; start of a reference period	Concept and examples
Business object	Business Object	Which information does the business use and produce?	Raw Data, Statistical Product, Classification	Concept and examples
Contract	Contract	Which formal agreement governs a service or exchange?	A data provision agreement with a register holder	Concept and examples
Representation	Representation	In which perceptible form is information made available?	A press release, a statistical table, an API response	Concept and examples
Product	Product	Which coherent set of services and information is offered to users?	A statistical product with its publication and data services	Concept and examples

SAF-specific concepts for the data value chain

Concept	Definition
Business domain	A coherent part of the statistical process that adds one specific kind of statistical value to data and is governed as a unit. In ArchiMate, a business domain is modelled as a grouping.
Data state	A defined condition of data, characterised by the processing it has undergone and the quality criteria it meets.
Steady state	A data state that is stored, versioned, quality-assured and registered, so that it can be handed over and reused.

Concept	Definition
Quality gate	The set of criteria that data must meet before it may be registered in a state.
Quality version	An immutable, identified version of a dataset that has passed a quality gate.
Handover interface	The agreement between a producing and a consuming domain: the artefact, its required metadata, the triggering event and the transfer of responsibility.
Reference model	A generic arrangement of domains, states and handover points that an NSI can adopt and adapt, such as the Steady-State or Medallion Architecture.

How the business architecture is built up

ArchiMate describes each layer with three aspects: *who* acts (active structure), *what* happens (behaviour) and *what* is acted upon (passive structure). The SAF business architecture follows these aspects, and then brings them together in two integrating views.

PLACEHOLDER: Structure of the SAF business architecture: three ArchiMate aspects and two integrating views

Part	Elements	Question
Active structure	Actors, roles, collaborations, interfaces	*Who* does the work, and through which channels?
Behaviour	Processes, functions, services, events	*What* happens, in which order, and what triggers it?
Passive structure	Business objects, contracts, representations, products	*Which* information is used, agreed and delivered?
Integrating view 1	Mapping of processes and functions to value stream stages	*How* do processes, functions and value streams fit together?
Integrating view 2	Reference models for the data value chain: Steady-State and Medallion	*Where* is data handed over, and with which quality?

Functions and processes

Functions and processes are easily confused, but they are different.

A **business function** groups behaviour by the knowledge, skills and resources it needs. Functions are stable. They have no start or end, and they do not depend on the order of work. *Manage Quality* is a function: it exists as long as the NSI exists.

A **business process** is a sequence of activities that leads to a defined result. A process has a trigger, a start and an end. *Collect* is a process: it starts when a collection period opens and ends when the data is stored and checked.

The two cross each other. One process uses several functions, and one function contributes to several processes. In ArchiMate, functions and processes are connected through realisation and assignment relationships. Statistical production is the clearest example: the production function is realised by the production process, which the SAF describes in detail.

Processes and the data value chain

The process view and the data value chain look at the same production from two angles. The process follows the life cycle of one statistical product, from need to evaluation. The data value chain follows the data, from source to release, across products.

Each business domain uses the same four process types, Design, Implementation, Execution and Management, which connect the two angles. They and their GSBPM phases are described in *The four process types* in the Statistical Data Value Chain chapter.

The GSBPM phases 4 to 7 run across several business domains. *Process* (phase 5), for example, spans standardisation, editing and part of estimation. The steady states mark where, within that flow, data is handed over with a defined quality.

Generic and model-specific content

Actors, roles, processes, functions, services, events and objects are generic. They apply to every NSI, whatever reference model it chooses for its data value chain.

The data value chain is model-specific. The business domains, steady states and quality gates differ between the Steady-State and the Medallion Architecture. That is why the SAF compares the reference models at the end of this chapter, and describes the Steady-State model in its own chapter, *Steady-State Architecture*.

Structure of this chapter

Section	Content	SAF content
Business Actors, Business Roles and Business Collaborations	Who is involved in statistical production, and with which responsibilities	Reference
Business Processes	The SAF process model, based on GSBPM	Reference
Business Functions	The SAF function model	Reference
Business Services, Events and Objects	Services and interfaces (reference); events, objects, contracts, representations and products (concept and examples)	Planned
Reference Models for the Statistical Data Value Chain	Reference models for the data value chain: comparison, selection criteria and combination. The Steady-State model is detailed in the *Steady-State Architecture* chapter, and the work per value stream in the *Statistical Data Value Chain* chapter	Reference

Readers who want to understand the statistical data value chain can go straight to the last section. Readers who want to map their own organisation onto the SAF start with actors and roles, and with the function model.

Business Actors, Business Roles and Business Collaborations

The concepts

A **business actor** is a person, team or organisation that can perform behaviour. An actor is a real entity. It exists whether or not it takes part in a specific process. Examples are a ministry that supplies a register, a research institute, or the NSI itself. In the SAF, actors are described as types, not as named organisations.

A **business role** is a responsibility for performing specific behaviour. A role says what someone is accountable for, not who that someone is. One actor can take on several roles, and one role can be filled by several actors. A methodologist in a small NSI may also act as statistical designer. A large NSI may have a whole team in the role of data steward.

A **business collaboration** is a group of actors or roles that work together for a shared purpose. A collaboration performs behaviour that none of its members can perform alone. It can be permanent, such as a data governance board, or temporary, such as a project team. Collaborations can also cross the boundaries of the NSI. A data sharing partnership between an NSI and a register holder is an example.

Actors, roles and collaborations are different from stakeholders (see *Stakeholders* in the Motivation chapter). A stakeholder has an interest in the architecture. An actor or role performs work in it. The same organisation can be both. A data provider is a stakeholder with concerns about burden, and an actor that delivers data in VS-01.

How the SAF applies actors, roles and collaborations

Why the SAF describes actors, roles and collaborations

Roles make responsibilities explicit. A steady state needs a data owner. A quality gate needs someone who decides. A release needs someone who approves. Without defined roles, these decisions are taken by whoever happens to be involved. That makes accountability unclear and audits difficult. Defined roles also make NSIs comparable. When two NSIs both use the role *data steward*, they can compare practices and share solutions.

How actors, roles and collaborations fit into an NSI's own architecture

The SAF offers a reference set of actor types, roles and collaborations. An NSI maps its own organisation onto this set. It links its departments and teams to actor types, and its job profiles to roles. One job profile often covers several SAF roles, especially in small NSIs. The mapping shows which roles are filled, which are combined, and which are missing. An NSI can then assign roles to processes, for example with a RACI matrix (responsible, accountable, consulted, informed).

The SAF roles are deliberately generic. The value streams use more specific role names, such as *Estimation Methodologist* or *Imputation Specialist*. These are specialisations of the reference roles. The mapping table at the end of this section shows how they relate.

Relationships with other concepts

Related concept	Relationship	Example in the SAF
Stakeholders (Motivation)	A stakeholder can also be an actor	A data provider is a stakeholder and an actor in VS-01
Business processes	Roles are assigned to processes	The data steward is assigned to *Register Raw Data*
Business functions	Roles are assigned to functions	The quality manager is assigned to *Manage Quality*
Business services and interfaces	Actors and roles offer or use services through interfaces	A researcher uses the microdata access service through a secure portal
Steady states	Each steady state has an owner, a steward and a custodian	The data owner of State #3 decides on access to processed microdata

Related concept	Relationship	Example in the SAF
Capabilities (Strategy)	Roles are part of the resources that realise capabilities	Methodologists are a key resource for Methodology (2.2.3)

PLACEHOLDER: ArchiMate view of SAF actors, roles and collaborations

SAF business actors

The SAF distinguishes nine actor types. They are grouped by their position relative to the NSI.

ID	Actor	Position	Description
ACT-01	National Statistical Institute	Internal	The NSI is the organisation that produces official statistics under a legal mandate. It is the central actor in the SAF. The NSI owns the statistical processes and is accountable for the quality and confidentiality of its output. It enters into agreements with data providers, users and partners. In the architecture, the NSI as a whole is the actor that offers business services to society.
ACT-02	Organisational unit	Internal	An organisational unit is a department, division or team within the NSI. Units are the actors that actually carry out the work. Each unit fills one or more roles, such as data collection, methodology or dissemination. The SAF does not prescribe an organisation structure. An NSI maps its own units onto the SAF roles, so that it can see which unit is responsible for which part of the chain.

ID	Actor	Position	Description
ACT-03	Data provider	External, supplies data	A data provider is an organisation that supplies data it holds to the NSI. Examples are government agencies with administrative registers, businesses with transaction data, and platform operators. The data is collected for another purpose and reused for statistics. Delivery usually takes place under a legal obligation or a data provision agreement. The NSI cannot control the quality at the source, but it can influence it through agreements and feedback.
ACT-04	Respondent	External, supplies data	A respondent is a person, household or business that provides data directly to the NSI, usually through a survey. Respondents answer questionnaires on the web, by telephone, face to face or on paper. Their burden is a constant concern for the NSI. Respondents are protected by statistical confidentiality: the NSI may not disclose their individual data. The NSI also has a duty to explain why it needs the data and how it uses it.

ID	Actor	Position	Description
ACT-05	Data user	External, uses output	A data user is a person or organisation that uses the output of the NSI. Users include policy makers, researchers, journalists, businesses and members of the public. Their needs differ widely. A minister needs a clear figure, a researcher needs microdata under strict conditions, and a developer needs a reliable API. The NSI groups users into segments, so that it can design services and channels for each segment.
ACT-06	Other producer of official statistics	Statistical system	Many countries have more than one producer of official statistics. Examples are central banks, ministries with statistical units and regional statistical offices. The NSI often coordinates this national statistical system. Producers exchange data, align methods and share infrastructure. In the architecture, they are partners in collaborations and sometimes providers or users of each other's data.

ID	Actor	Position	Description
ACT-07	International statistical organisation	Statistical system	International statistical organisations set standards, coordinate statistics across countries and collect national data. Examples are UNECE, Eurostat, the OECD, the IMF and the UN Statistics Division. They require NSIs to deliver data in agreed formats and on agreed dates. They also develop the shared models that the SAF builds on, such as GSBPM and GSIM. For the NSI, they are users, standard setters and partners in collaboration.
ACT-08	Supervisory and legal authority	External, oversees	A supervisory or legal authority oversees whether the NSI acts within the law. Examples are the data protection authority, a national statistics council, the national audit office and the courts. Some authorities grant the legal basis for data collection. Others assess compliance after the fact. The NSI must be able to show these authorities how it handles data, which is one reason why traceability is a core concern of the SAF.

ID	Actor	Position	Description
ACT-09	Supplier and service provider	External, supports	A supplier delivers goods or services that the NSI needs but does not produce itself. Examples are software vendors, cloud and hosting providers, field work agencies and trusted third parties for pseudonymisation. Suppliers work under contracts that set requirements for security, confidentiality and continuity. When a supplier processes statistical data, the NSI remains accountable for it. The choice of suppliers is guided by SAF-P01 and by the NSI's sourcing strategy.

SAF business roles

The SAF reference set contains 24 roles in seven groups. The column *Process type* shows in which of the four process types of a business domain (design, implementation, execution, management) the role mainly works.

Governance and accountability

ID	Role	Process type	Description
ROL-01	Process owner	Management	The process owner is accountable for the end-to-end performance of a business domain or value stream. This role sets the objectives of the process and decides on changes to it. The process owner makes sure the process has the people, methods and systems it needs. The role receives the quality reports of the management process and acts on them. In the steady-state model, each business domain has one process owner.

ID	Role	Process type	Description
ROL-02	Data owner	Management	The data owner is accountable for a dataset or a steady state. This role decides who may access the data, for which purpose and under which conditions. The data owner also approves the retention period and the classification of the data. The role is usually held by a manager in the domain that produces the data. Data ownership is a business role, not an IT role: the data owner answers for the content, not for the storage.
ROL-03	Data steward	Execution	The data steward takes care of data on behalf of the data owner. This role registers datasets in the catalogue and maintains their metadata. The data steward checks that data meets the quality gate before it is registered. The role also handles questions from users and resolves exceptions. Data stewards are the daily point of contact for anyone who wants to find or use a dataset.
ROL-04	Data custodian	Execution	The data custodian is responsible for the safe storage and technical management of data. This role runs storage, backup and access control according to the decisions of the data owner. The custodian carries out retention and disposal. The role does not decide on the use of the data, but makes sure that decisions are applied correctly. In many NSIs, the custodian role is held by an IT or platform team.

ID	Role	Process type	Description
ROL-05	Chief data officer	Management	The chief data officer is accountable for data governance across the whole NSI. This role sets the data policy and the governance framework. It assigns the data owner, steward and custodian roles to people and units. The chief data officer chairs or supports the data governance board. The role is the escalation point for conflicts about data that cross domain boundaries.

Design

ID	Role	Process type	Description
ROL-06	Statistical designer	Design	The statistical designer translates information needs into the design of a statistical product. This role defines the outputs, the variables, the population and the required data. The designer specifies the processes that produce the product, in close cooperation with the methodologist. The role is the link between users and production. In some NSIs this role is called product manager.

ID	Role	Process type	Description
ROL-07	Methodologist	Design	The methodologist designs and assesses the statistical methods. This role covers sampling, collection methods, editing and imputation, estimation and quality measurement. The methodologist makes sure methods are sound, documented and reproducible. The role also evaluates new methods before they enter production. Specialisations exist for each step of the chain, such as estimation or editing.
ROL-08	Metadata and data architect	Design	The metadata and data architect designs the structure of data and metadata. This role defines data models, metadata schemas and the minimum metadata set of each steady state. The architect makes sure that data from different sources can be combined and compared. The role works with standards such as GSIM and SDMX. It is the bridge between the business architecture and the data architecture.

ID	Role	Process type	Description
ROL-09	Classification steward	Design	The classification steward manages the classifications and code lists that the NSI uses. This role maintains national versions of international classifications, such as NACE or ISCO. The steward manages correspondence tables between versions. The role makes sure that all domains use the same version at the same time. Changes to a classification are announced and documented before they take effect.

Implementation

ID	Role	Process type	Description
ROL-10	Data engineer	Implementation	The data engineer builds the technical processes that move and transform data. This role develops ingestion pipelines, collection channels and processing workflows. The data engineer implements the designs of the statistical designer and the methodologist. The role also builds the automated checks that support the quality gates. The data engineer works closely with the platform engineer, who provides the environment.

ID	Role	Process type	Description
ROL-11	Platform engineer	Implementation	The platform engineer provides and runs the environments in which the processes operate. This role configures platforms, storage, connectors and access controls. The platform engineer keeps environments secure, available and up to date. The role supports all value streams but is anchored in VS-09. In many NSIs, the role is also called system configurator or DevOps engineer.
ROL-12	Test manager	Implementation	The test manager plans and coordinates the testing of new or changed processes. This role covers technical tests, integration tests and field tests. The test manager checks that a process produces the expected result before it goes into production. The role reports test results to the process owner. Testing is required before any change to a process that produces a steady state.

Execution

ID	Role	Process type	Description
ROL-13	Data collection manager	Execution	The data collection manager runs data collection campaigns. This role plans the collection period, coordinates field staff and monitors response. The manager follows up on non-response and late deliveries. The role also handles contacts with respondents and data providers during collection. The data collection manager reports on collection progress and quality to the process owner.
ROL-14	Data quality analyst	Execution	The data quality analyst checks data during processing. This role runs validation checks, assesses results against the quality gate and logs exceptions. The analyst investigates errors and outliers and proposes corrections. The role documents quality indicators for each version of a dataset. Data quality analysts are active at every handover point in the chain.
ROL-15	Subject-matter statistician	Execution	The subject-matter statistician has in-depth knowledge of a statistical domain, such as labour market or prices. This role interprets results, checks plausibility and explains developments. The statistician carries out or supervises editing, estimation and analysis in the domain. The role writes or reviews the texts that accompany a release. Subject-matter statisticians are the experts that users and journalists turn to.

ID	Role	Process type	Description
ROL-16	Disclosure control specialist	Design, Execution	The disclosure control specialist protects the confidentiality of respondents in the output. This role designs and applies disclosure control methods, such as suppression, rounding and noise. The specialist assesses the disclosure risk of tables, microdata and services. The role works at State #4 and at the gate to State #5. No output is released without a disclosure check that this role has approved.
ROL-17	Release manager	Execution	The release manager controls the publication of statistical output. This role makes sure that releases follow the release calendar and the embargo rules. The release manager checks that the output has been approved and has passed disclosure control. The role coordinates the release across channels, such as the website, the API and press releases. Equal access for all users at the moment of release is a key responsibility.

Assurance

ID	Role	Process type	Description
ROL-18	Quality manager	Management	The quality manager is responsible for the quality framework of the NSI. This role defines quality indicators and monitors them across the chain. The quality manager produces quality reports and leads improvement actions. The role supports process owners in the management process of their domains. It also prepares the NSI for quality reviews, such as peer reviews against the European Statistics Code of Practice.
ROL-19	Compliance officer	Management	The compliance officer makes sure that the NSI complies with laws and regulations. This role covers statistical law, data protection law and other applicable rules. The officer checks new processes and methods against compliance criteria before they go into production. The role keeps the legal register up to date. In many NSIs the data protection officer is a specific form of this role.
ROL-20	Security officer	Management	The security officer is responsible for information security and continuity. This role defines security measures and monitors their application. The officer manages security incidents and leads recovery when something goes wrong. The role assesses the security of new solutions and suppliers. It works closely with the platform engineer and the compliance officer.

ID	Role	Process type	Description
ROL-21	Auditor	Management	The auditor checks independently whether processes and controls work as intended. This role can be internal, such as an internal audit department, or external, such as the national audit office or a certification body. The auditor reviews evidence, such as logs, quality reports and lineage records. The role reports findings to management and to supervisory authorities. Its work depends on the traceability that the SAF builds into the chain.

Users and partners

ID	Role	Process type	Description
ROL-22	Dissemination and service manager	Design, Execution	The dissemination and service manager designs and manages the services through which users receive output. This role covers publications, open data, APIs and microdata access. The manager defines channels and formats for each user segment. The role manages the portfolio of services and their service levels. It works with the release manager on the timing and with the relationship manager on user needs.

ID	Role	Process type	Description
ROL-23	Relationship manager	Execution	The relationship manager maintains the relationships with key external actors. These include data providers, major users, partners and international organisations. The manager collects needs, feedback and complaints, and passes them to the right roles. The role negotiates and maintains agreements, such as data provision agreements. Relationship managers make sure that the NSI speaks with one voice to each partner.

Support

ID	Role	Process type	Description
ROL-24	Enterprise architect	Design, Management	The enterprise architect develops and maintains the enterprise architecture of the NSI. This role translates strategy into architecture and uses the SAF as its reference. The architect advises on investments and reviews projects against the architecture principles. The role supports the architecture board and keeps the architecture repository up to date. It is the role that realises the capability *Architecture management*.

SAF business collaborations

ID	Collaboration	Members	Type	Description
COL-01	Data provision partnership	NSI, data provider, relationship manager, data owner	External, permanent	A data provision partnership is the long-term cooperation between the NSI and a data provider. It goes beyond a single delivery. The partners agree on content, format, timing and quality of the data. They also agree on how to handle changes at the source, such as a new system or a new definition. A good partnership reduces the burden for the provider and improves the quality for the NSI.
COL-02	National statistical system	NSI, other producers of official statistics	External, permanent	The national statistical system is the cooperation between all producers of official statistics in one country. The NSI usually coordinates it. The members align methods, classifications and release practices, so that national statistics are consistent. They exchange data and sometimes share infrastructure. The cooperation is often based on the national statistics law.

ID	Collaboration	Members	Type	Description
COL-03	International statistical cooperation	NSI, international statistical organisations, other NSIs	External, permanent	International statistical cooperation is the collaboration between NSIs and international organisations. It covers the development of standards, the exchange of data and the joint development of tools. The SAF itself is a product of this cooperation. Members take part in working groups, such as those of UNECE and the European Statistical System. The cooperation helps NSIs avoid building the same solution many times.
COL-04	Research access partnership	NSI, research institutes, data owner, disclosure control specialist	External, permanent	A research access partnership gives researchers access to microdata under strict conditions. The NSI, research institutes and sometimes funding bodies take part. The partners agree on who may access which data, for which purpose and in which environment. Output is checked for disclosure risk before it leaves the secure environment. The partnership supports science while protecting the confidentiality of respondents.

ID	Collaboration	Members	Type	Description
COL-05	Statistical product team	Statistical designer, methodologist, data engineer, subject-matter statistician	Internal, permanent or temporary	A statistical product team brings together the roles needed to design, build and run a statistical product. It typically includes a statistical designer, a methodologist, a data engineer and a subject-matter statistician. The team can be permanent for a product or temporary for a redesign. Working as one team shortens the path from design to production. It also makes sure that methodological and technical choices are made together.
COL-06	Data governance board	Chief data officer, data owners, data stewards, compliance officer	Internal, permanent	The data governance board steers data management across the NSI. The chief data officer chairs it, and data owners, data stewards and the compliance officer take part. The board sets data policies, resolves conflicts between domains and monitors compliance. It decides on access requests that cross domain boundaries. The board makes sure that the steady-state model is applied consistently.

ID	Collaboration	Members	Type	Description
COL-07	Architecture board	Enterprise architect, process owners, CIO or CTO	Internal, permanent	The architecture board steers the enterprise architecture of the NSI. The enterprise architect, process owners and the CIO or CTO take part. The board reviews projects against the architecture principles and the target architecture. It decides on deviations through a documented dispensation process. The board keeps the architecture aligned with the strategy and with the SAF.

Role names in the value streams

The value streams use specific role names that fit their context. The table shows how they relate to the reference roles. A specialised role inherits the responsibilities of its reference role and adds those specific to its value stream.

Role name in the value streams	Reference role
Process Owner; Process Owners (VS-01…VS-10)	ROL-01 Process owner
Data Owner / Steward / Custodian	ROL-02 Data owner; ROL-03 Data steward; ROL-04 Data custodian
Chief Data / Governance Officer	ROL-05 Chief data officer
Statistical Designer; Product Manager; Model Designer; Derivation Designer; Coherence Designer	ROL-06 Statistical designer
Methodologist; Estimation Methodologist; Editing Methodologist; Imputation Specialist; Indicator/Index Methodologist; Head of Methodology / Innovation	ROL-07 Methodologist
Metadata Architect; Data Architect	ROL-08 Metadata and data architect
Classification Steward; Coding Specialist	ROL-09 Classification steward
Data Engineer; Integration Specialist; Integration Engineer; Tool / Platform Engineer	ROL-10 Data engineer
System Configurator; DevOps / Platform Engineer; Platform / Cloud Architect; Service Desk / Operations	ROL-11 Platform engineer
Test Manager	ROL-12 Test manager
Data Collection Manager	ROL-13 Data collection manager
Data Quality Analyst	ROL-14 Data quality analyst

Role name in the value streams	Reference role
Subject-Matter Analyst; Subject-Matter Reviewer; Subject-Matter Author; Subject-Matter Expert; Survey Statistician; Analyst / Modeler; Researcher / Data Scientist	ROL-15 Subject-matter statistician
Disclosure-Control Designer	ROL-16 Disclosure control specialist
Release Manager; Approval Authority	ROL-17 Release manager
Quality Manager	ROL-18 Quality manager
Compliance Officer; Legal Counsel	ROL-19 Compliance officer
Security & Continuity Officer	ROL-20 Security officer
Internal / External Auditor	ROL-21 Auditor
Dissemination Manager; Channel/Service Designer; Open-Data / API Product Owner; Service / Product Portfolio Manager; User-Support Lead; Service Desk / User Support	ROL-22 Dissemination and service manager
Account / Relationship Manager; Engagement / Communications Officer; Communications / Outreach Officer; Head of Communication / Engagement; User Researcher; Impact Analyst	ROL-23 Relationship manager
Chief Technology / Infrastructure Officer	Actor: management of the NSI (ACT-01); member of COL-07
Trainer / Knowledge Manager	Not included in the reference set
Data Provider; Survey Respondent; Data User; Legal Authority; Standards Body; Methodology Authority	Actors ACT-03, ACT-04, ACT-05, ACT-08, ACT-07

Toolkit (planned): Role mapping and RACI template

Business Processes

The concept

A **business process** is a sequence of activities that produces a defined result for a customer, a stakeholder or another process. A process has a trigger, a start and an end. It has inputs and outputs, and it uses the knowledge and resources of one or more business functions. Processes describe *how* work flows, step by step. They are the part of the business architecture that people recognise most directly in their daily work.

Processes can be decomposed. A high-level process consists of sub-processes, which can in turn be broken down further. The SAF describes processes at two levels: process phases or process groups, and the sub-processes within them. More detailed levels, such as work instructions, are specific to each NSI and fall outside the SAF.

A process is not the same as a value stream stage. A value stream stage describes the value that is added. A process describes the work that adds it. One stage is usually realised by several processes, and one process can contribute to several stages.

How the SAF applies business processes

Why the SAF describes business processes

Processes are where architecture meets daily operations. A shared process model lets NSIs compare how they work, reuse each other's solutions and discuss improvements in the same terms. It also links the strategic layer to the systems: value streams are realised by processes, and processes are supported by application services. Without a process model, it is hard to show which system supports which part of the work, or where a change in method affects other steps.

How business processes fit into an NSI's own architecture

The core of the SAF process model is GSBPM, which most NSIs already know. The SAF adds three process groups that GSBPM does not describe in detail: data management and lifecycle, microdata services and data spaces. An NSI adopts the process model as a reference, maps its own processes onto it and adds its own lower levels. A national process for, say, the monthly price index can then be traced to the SAF sub-processes it implements. The SAF does not prescribe the order of sub-processes. GSBPM is not a strict sequence: sub-processes can be skipped, repeated or run in parallel.

Relationships with other concepts

Related concept	Relationship	Example in the SAF
Value streams (Strategy)	Processes realise value stream stages	PRD-4.3 *Run collection* realises VS-01.3 *Collect or Receive Data*
Capabilities (Strategy)	Processes realise capabilities	PRD-5.4 *Edit and impute* realises Adjusting and imputing (1.3.4)
Business functions	Processes realise functions; functions are assigned to processes	The production process realises the production function
Business roles	Roles are assigned to processes	ROL-14 *Data quality analyst* is assigned to PRD-5.3 *Review and validate*
Business events	Events trigger processes and mark their results	*Collection period opened* triggers PRD-4.3
Business objects	Processes access business objects	PRD-5.8 *Finalise data files* writes the processed microdata
Steady states	Processes produce and consume steady states	DLM-3 *Register and catalogue data* registers a dataset in a steady state
Application services	Application services serve processes	A validation service serves PRD-5.3

Process groups

Group	IDs	Basis	Scope
A. Statistical production	PRD-1 to PRD-8	GSBPM phases and sub-processes	The production of a statistical product, from need to evaluation
B. Overarching processes	OVA-1 to OVA-6	GSBPM overarching processes	Activities that run across all production phases
C. Data management and lifecycle	DLM-1 to DLM-11	SAF	The management of data assets and steady states across products
D. Microdata services	MDS-1 to MDS-9	SAF	Controlled access to microdata for research
E. Data spaces	DSP-1 to DSP-6	SAF	Participation in data spaces, as data provider and data user

PLACEHOLDER: ArchiMate view of the SAF process model

A. Statistical production processes

The statistical production processes follow the eight phases of GSBPM. Each phase is described first, followed by its sub-processes. The descriptions are paraphrased from GSBPM, a model of UNECE published under the Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 licence (CC BY 4.0).

PRD-1 Specify Needs

ID	Process	Description
PRD-1	**Specify Needs**	This phase starts when a new statistical need is identified, or when an existing product needs review. It establishes what users need and whether the NSI can meet that need. The phase explores options, including the use of data that already exists. It ends with a decision on whether to proceed, based on a business case. For existing products that run regularly, this phase is usually carried out only when a review is due.
PRD-1.1	Identify needs	This sub-process investigates which statistics are needed and what they are needed for. The trigger can be a new policy question, a legal requirement or a user request. It also looks at changes in the needs for existing statistics. Input comes from users, stakeholders, legislation and earlier evaluations. The result is a first description of the need.
PRD-1.2	Consult and confirm needs	This sub-process consults users and stakeholders to understand the need in detail. It checks what exactly they want to know, at which level of detail and how often. It also explores which constraints apply, such as timing or budget. The NSI and the users confirm the need together. The result is a confirmed and documented set of needs.
PRD-1.3	Establish output objectives	This sub-process translates the confirmed needs into output objectives. It defines which statistics will be produced and which quality they must meet. Legal and confidentiality constraints are taken into account. The objectives are realistic for the data and resources that are available. The result is the basis for the design of the outputs.

ID	Process	Description
PRD-1.4	Identify concepts	This sub-process clarifies the concepts to be measured, from the point of view of the users. A concept such as “household income” or “unemployment” needs a clear meaning. The sub-process checks whether existing statistical concepts can be reused. Concepts may not yet match the definitions that data sources use. That mismatch is resolved later, in the design phase.
PRD-1.5	Check data availability and suitability	This sub-process checks whether existing data sources can meet the need. It looks at internal data, administrative data, data spaces and other external sources. For each source, it assesses quality, coverage, timeliness and legal conditions. Reusing existing data comes before new collection, in line with SAF-P08. The result shows which gaps remain that new data must fill.
PRD-1.6	Prepare and submit business case	This sub-process documents the findings of the phase in a business case. The business case describes the need, the proposed solution, the costs and the benefits. It also lists risks and alternatives. The business case is submitted to management for a decision. Approval starts the design phase.

PRD-2 Design

ID	Process	Description
PRD-2	**Design**	This phase designs the statistical product and the process that produces it. It covers outputs, variables, collection, sampling, processing, analysis and dissemination. It also defines the metadata and the quality criteria. Designs reuse existing standards, methods and components wherever possible. The results are the specifications for the build phase.

ID	Process	Description
PRD-2.1	Design outputs and dissemination	This sub-process designs the statistical outputs in detail. It defines tables, datasets, indicators and their metadata. It also designs how and through which channels the outputs will be disseminated. Disclosure control requirements are taken into account from the start. The design follows the output objectives from PRD-1.3.
PRD-2.2	Design variables	This sub-process defines the variables to be collected and to be derived. It specifies their definitions, the types of statistical units and the classifications that apply. Existing variables and classifications are reused where possible. Each variable gets metadata that describes its meaning. The result is a variable list that all later phases use.
PRD-2.3	Design collection	This sub-process determines how the data will be collected. It chooses the sources, the collection modes and the instruments, such as questionnaires or data interfaces. For administrative data and data spaces, it designs the agreements and delivery formats. Respondent burden is kept as low as possible. The design also covers the metadata and paradata to be captured.
PRD-2.4	Design frame and sample	This sub-process defines the target population and the frame from which units are selected. It designs the sampling method and the sample size, where a sample is used. For register-based statistics, it defines how the population is derived from the registers. Coverage problems in the frame are identified and addressed. The result is the method used later in PRD-4.1.

ID	Process	Description
PRD-2.5	Design processing and analysis	This sub-process designs the methods for processing and analysis. It covers integration, coding, validation, editing, imputation, derivation, weighting and estimation. It also designs the methods for disclosure control. Methods are documented so that results can be reproduced. The designs are reviewed by methodologists before they are built.
PRD-2.6	Design production systems and workflows	This sub-process designs the end-to-end workflow of the statistical process. It defines which systems and components are needed for each step. It avoids gaps and duplication between steps. Reuse of existing components and shared platforms comes first, in line with SAF-P01. The result is the blueprint for the build phase.

PRD-3 Build

ID	Process	Description
PRD-3	**Build**	This phase builds and tests the production solution. It assembles the components, configures the workflows and tests the whole process. Components are reused where possible and built only where needed. The phase ends when the process is ready for production. For regular products, this phase is only needed when something changes.
PRD-3.1	Reuse or build collection instruments	This sub-process builds or reuses the instruments for data collection. Examples are electronic questionnaires, data delivery interfaces and connectors to data spaces. It follows the design from PRD-2.3. Instruments are tested for usability and correctness. The result is a set of instruments ready for collection.

ID	Process	Description
PRD-3.2	Reuse or build processing and analysis components	This sub-process builds or reuses the components for processing and analysis. Examples are validation rules, imputation routines and estimation programmes. The components implement the methods designed in PRD-2.5. Shared components that other products already use are preferred. Each component is documented and version-controlled.
PRD-3.3	Reuse or build dissemination components	This sub-process builds or reuses the components for dissemination. Examples are table templates, publication workflows and API endpoints. It follows the design from PRD-2.1. Shared dissemination platforms are used where possible. The components are tested together with the output systems.
PRD-3.4	Configure workflows	This sub-process configures the workflows that connect the components. It sets up the order of steps, the data flows and the transformations. It also configures the registration of data in the steady states. Configuration is preferred over custom code. The result is an executable workflow.
PRD-3.5	Test production systems	This sub-process tests the assembled systems and their interactions. It checks that components work together and handle errors correctly. It also tests performance and security. Test results are documented and reported to the process owner. Defects are fixed before the process goes live.
PRD-3.6	Test statistical business process	This sub-process tests the whole statistical process in practice. It can take the form of a pilot or a field test with real data. It checks that the process produces results of the expected quality. Problems found in the test lead to changes in design or build. The process owner decides whether the process is ready.

ID	Process	Description
PRD-3.7	Finalise production systems	This sub-process puts the process and its systems into production. It completes the documentation and trains the staff involved. It transfers the systems to the teams that will run and maintain them. The metadata of the process is registered. From this moment, the process can run in the collect to disseminate phases.

PRD-4 Collect

ID	Process	Description
PRD-4	**Collect**	This phase collects or acquires the data, metadata and paradata needed for the product. It covers surveys, administrative data, data from data spaces and other sources. Data is received securely and checked for completeness. The phase ends when the data is stored and registered as raw data. In the steady-state model, this phase produces State #1.
PRD-4.1	Create frame and select sample	This sub-process creates the frame for this iteration of the process. It applies the method designed in PRD-2.4 to the current population. Where a sample is used, it draws the sample. The quality of the frame and the sample is checked. The result is the list of units from which data will be collected.
PRD-4.2	Set up collection	This sub-process makes sure that people, processes and systems are ready to collect. It prepares the instruments, trains interviewers and informs respondents or data providers. It checks that agreements and access rights are in place. Collection channels are tested before collection starts. The collection period is planned and communicated.
PRD-4.3	Run collection	This sub-process carries out the collection. Respondents complete questionnaires, and data providers deliver their data. Progress and response are monitored continuously. Non-response is followed up within the agreed strategy. Paradata about the collection is recorded.

ID	Process	Description
PRD-4.4	Finalise collection	This sub-process loads the collected data and metadata into a secure environment. It checks integrity, completeness and structure at intake. It registers the data as a new version of raw data. Delivery problems are reported to the data provider. The collection is closed when all expected data has been received or written off.

PRD-5 Process

ID	Process	Description
PRD-5	**Process**	This phase turns the collected data into microdata that is ready for analysis. It integrates, classifies, checks, corrects and derives data. It also calculates weights and aggregates. The phase runs across several business domains of the steady-state model. It produces States #2 and #3, and the first aggregates of State #4.
PRD-5.1	Integrate data	This sub-process combines data from one or more sources into a consistent dataset. It links records that describe the same unit, using agreed keys. It resolves overlaps and conflicts between sources. Linkage uses pseudonymised keys where personal data is involved. The result is an integrated dataset with documented linkage quality.
PRD-5.2	Classify and code	This sub-process assigns codes from standard classifications to the data. Examples are codes for economic activity, occupation or region. Coding can be automatic, manual or a mix of both. The classification versions used are recorded in the metadata. Coding quality is checked and documented.

ID	Process	Description
PRD-5.3	Review and validate	This sub-process checks the data for errors, outliers and inconsistencies. It applies the validation rules designed in PRD-2.5. It flags records that need attention. Some checks run automatically, others need expert review. The result is a dataset with quality flags and a list of issues.
PRD-5.4	Edit and impute	This sub-process corrects incorrect values and fills in missing values. Corrections follow editing rules, and missing values are imputed with documented methods. Every change is recorded, so that the original value can always be traced. The impact of editing and imputation on the results is measured. The result is a complete and consistent dataset.
PRD-5.5	Derive new variables and units	This sub-process creates variables and units that were not collected directly. Examples are age groups, household composition or enterprise groups. Derivations follow the specifications from PRD-2.2. Derived variables get their own metadata. The derivation rules are documented and reusable.
PRD-5.6	Calculate weights	This sub-process calculates weights for the records in the dataset. Weights correct for the sample design, non-response and coverage. They follow the method designed in PRD-2.5. The quality of the weights is checked. The weights are stored with the microdata.
PRD-5.7	Calculate aggregates	This sub-process calculates totals and other aggregates from the microdata. It applies the weights and the estimation methods. It can also combine lower-level aggregates into higher levels. Accuracy measures are calculated alongside the estimates. The result is the first version of the statistics.

ID	Process	Description
PRD-5.8	Finalise data files	This sub-process combines the results of the phase into the files used for analysis. It checks that the files are complete and consistent. It registers the processed microdata as a new version in the steady state. The metadata of the files is completed. The files are now ready for the analysis phase.

PRD-6 Analyse

ID	Process	Description
PRD-6	**Analyse**	This phase turns the processed data into statistical outputs and checks that they are fit for release. It prepares draft outputs, validates them and explains them. It also applies disclosure control. The phase ends with the approval of the content for release. In the steady-state model, it completes State #4.
PRD-6.1	Prepare draft outputs	This sub-process transforms the data files into draft statistical outputs. Examples are tables, indicators, time series and charts. It also prepares the methodological notes that go with them. Drafts follow the output design from PRD-2.1. They are the input for validation and interpretation.
PRD-6.2	Validate outputs	This sub-process checks the draft outputs for quality and plausibility. It compares results with earlier periods, other sources and expectations. It checks them against the quality framework. Unexpected results are investigated before they are accepted. The result is a set of validated outputs with documented quality.
PRD-6.3	Interpret and explain outputs	This sub-process interprets the outputs and explains what they mean. Subject-matter experts describe developments and their causes. Deeper analyses may be carried out to support the explanation. The interpretation must be neutral and based on the data. The result is the content for publications and press releases.

ID	Process	Description
PRD-6.4	Apply disclosure control	This sub-process makes sure that outputs do not reveal information about individual respondents. It applies the disclosure control methods designed in PRD-2.5. Examples are suppression of cells, rounding and adding noise. The disclosure risk is assessed and documented. No output is released without passing this check.
PRD-6.5	Finalise outputs	This sub-process makes sure that the statistics are fit for use. It completes the outputs and their metadata. It checks that all quality and confidentiality requirements are met. The content is approved for release by the responsible role. The approved outputs are registered as statistics ready for dissemination.

PRD-7 Disseminate

ID	Process	Description
PRD-7	**Disseminate**	This phase publishes the statistical products and supports users. It updates the output systems, produces the products and releases them. It also promotes the products and answers user questions. Equal access for all users at the moment of release is a core rule. In the steady-state model, this phase produces State #5.
PRD-7.1	Update output systems	This sub-process loads the approved data and metadata into the systems used for dissemination. Examples are databases behind the website, open data portals and APIs. It checks that the data is loaded correctly and remains embargoed until release. Format and structure follow the dissemination design. The result is output that is ready for release.

ID	Process	Description
PRD-7.2	Produce dissemination products	This sub-process produces the products that users receive. Examples are press releases, publications, tables, visualisations and datasets. It follows the design from PRD-2.1. Products are checked for correctness and consistency before release. The result is a set of products ready to publish.
PRD-7.3	Release dissemination products	This sub-process releases the products to users. It follows the release calendar and the embargo rules. All channels are updated at the same moment, so that no user gets an advantage. Errors found after release are corrected openly. The release is logged for accountability.
PRD-7.4	Promote dissemination products	This sub-process brings the products to the attention of users. It uses channels such as social media, newsletters and events. It targets the user segments that have an interest in the product. Promotion helps users find and understand the statistics. Its effect is monitored.
PRD-7.5	Provide user support	This sub-process answers questions and requests from users. Questions are registered and answered within agreed times. Frequent questions lead to better documentation or products. Requests for tailor-made data are handled according to confidentiality rules. Feedback from users is passed on to the product owners.

PRD-8 Evaluate

ID	Process	Description
PRD-8	**Evaluate**	This phase evaluates a specific run of the statistical process. It collects evidence, assesses quality and performance, and agrees on improvements. Evaluation can take place after every run or at set intervals. Its results feed back into the next run or into a redesign. The phase is part of the management process type of each business domain.

ID	Process	Description
PRD-8.1	Gather evaluation inputs	This sub-process collects the material for the evaluation. Examples are quality indicators, paradata, process logs, user feedback and staff comments. The inputs come from all earlier phases. They are brought together in one place. The result is a complete evidence base for the evaluation.
PRD-8.2	Conduct evaluation	This sub-process analyses the inputs and draws conclusions. It assesses the quality of the outputs and the efficiency of the process. It compares results with targets and with earlier runs. Strengths and weaknesses are identified. The result is an evaluation report or dashboard.
PRD-8.3	Agree an action plan	This sub-process agrees on actions to improve the process. It sets priorities, owners and deadlines. Actions can lead to small changes or to a full redesign. Progress on the actions is monitored. The action plan is the input for the next cycle.

B. Overarching processes

Overarching processes run across all phases of statistical production. They are not steps in the sequence. They apply to every phase, and to every product. They are based on the overarching processes of GSBPM.

ID	Process	Description
OVA-1	Quality Management	This process assesses and controls the quality of products and processes. It applies the quality framework of the NSI in every phase. It defines quality indicators, measures them and reports on them. Quality problems lead to corrective actions. The process supports the NSI-wide quality management function.

ID	Process	Description
OVA-2	Metadata Management	This process creates, updates, uses and archives statistical metadata in all phases. Metadata describes concepts, variables, classifications, methods and processes. It is captured when it is created, not afterwards. Metadata is shared through a catalogue, so that others can find and understand the data. The process applies SAF-P09 *No data without metadata and classification*.
OVA-3	Data Management	This process manages data throughout its life cycle in production. It covers storage, security, versioning, retention and disposal. It makes sure that data is available to the right people at the right time. The SAF details this process in group C, *Data management and lifecycle processes*. The process applies the design rules of the steady-state model.
OVA-4	Process Data Management	This process records and uses data about the execution of the statistical process. Examples are paradata from collection, logs of processing steps and timings. Process data shows how the process actually ran. It is used for monitoring, evaluation and audit. It is also the basis for lineage: the trace from output back to source.
OVA-5	Knowledge Management	This process maintains the knowledge needed to run the production process. It keeps documentation, methods and procedures up to date. It makes sure that recurring processes can be repeated in the same way. It also captures lessons learned from evaluations. Knowledge management reduces the dependence on individual staff members.

ID	Process	Description
OVA-6	Data Supplier Management	This process manages the technical and operational relationship with data suppliers during production. It covers delivery schedules, formats, quality feedback and problem resolution. It keeps track of the burden placed on suppliers. It works within the agreements made at corporate level. Good supplier management improves data quality and reduces delays.

C. Data management and lifecycle processes

These processes manage data as an asset, across products and over its whole life. They detail the overarching process OVA-3 *Data Management*. They follow the life cycle of a steady state: promotion, gate, registration, use, revision and retirement. They apply to every reference model for the data value chain.

ID	Process	Description
DLM-1	Plan and design data assets	This process decides which data assets the NSI needs and how they are structured. It defines datasets, their owners, their classification and their place in the steady states. It is triggered by a new product, a new source or a change in the data architecture. Planning prevents duplicate datasets and unclear ownership. The result is a documented design for each data asset.
DLM-2	Promote data through a quality gate	This process submits a dataset to the quality gate of a steady state. It checks the dataset against the gate criteria, such as completeness, structure and required metadata. The outcome is acceptance, conditional acceptance with quality flags, or rejection. Rejected data returns to the producing domain or the data provider. The process makes sure that only data of known quality enters a steady state.

ID	Process	Description
DLM-3	Register and catalogue data	This process registers an accepted dataset as a new, immutable version. It assigns a persistent identifier and records the metadata in the catalogue. It publishes an event that tells consuming domains a new version is available. Registration makes the data findable for authorised users. Without registration, data cannot be handed over.
DLM-4	Classify and protect data	This process assigns a security classification to each dataset, for availability, integrity and confidentiality. It applies the protection measures that follow from the classification. It also applies pseudonymisation or other privacy measures where required. Classification is reviewed when data moves to the next steady state. The process applies SAF-P09, SAF-P10 and SAF-P11.
DLM-5	Store and version data	This process stores each registered version of a dataset safely. Earlier versions are kept, not overwritten. Backups and recovery are arranged according to the availability requirements. Storage follows the retention policy of each steady state. The process makes it possible to reproduce any statistic from the data it was built on.
DLM-6	Provide data for reuse	This process gives authorised internal users access to registered data. A user requests access, and the data owner decides on the request. Access is granted for a stated purpose and a set period. Use is logged. The process applies SAF-P08 *Data is shared property*, within the limits of confidentiality.
DLM-7	Revise data	This process handles corrections and redeliveries of data that is already registered. A correction creates a new version that passes the same quality gate. Consumers of the earlier version are notified. They decide whether to reprocess their own data. The reason for each revision is recorded.

ID	Process	Description
DLM-8	Monitor data quality, lineage and use	This process monitors registered data over time. It tracks quality indicators, the lineage from source to output, and how the data is used. It detects problems, such as declining quality or unauthorised use. It reports to data owners and the data governance board. The results feed into improvements and audits.
DLM-9	Manage reference and master data	This process manages the data that other data depends on. Examples are classifications, code lists, statistical registers and population frames. It controls versions and publishes changes in advance. It makes sure that all domains use the same version at the same time. Errors in reference data affect many products, so changes are tested carefully.
DLM-10	Archive and preserve data	This process transfers data that must be kept long-term to an archive. It selects what must be preserved, based on legal obligations and reproducibility needs. It makes sure that archived data remains readable and understandable, with its metadata. Access to archived data is controlled. The process follows national archives legislation.
DLM-11	Dispose of data	This process deletes data at the end of its retention period. It checks that no statistic or obligation still depends on the data. Deletion covers all copies, including backups and working copies. Keys used for pseudonymisation are destroyed when they are no longer needed. Each disposal is recorded, so that it can be shown in an audit.

D. Microdata services processes

Microdata services give researchers controlled access to microdata for statistical and scientific research. Access takes place under strict conditions, usually in a secure processing environment. The NSI remains responsible for confidentiality throughout. These processes realise part of VS-06 *Dissemination and Service Delivery* and work within the collaboration COL-04 *Research access partnership*.

ID	Process	Description
MDS-1	Authorise institutions and researchers	This process decides which institutions and researchers may use microdata services. It checks the legal status of the institution and the qualifications of the researchers. Authorised institutions sign an agreement that sets the conditions of use. Researchers confirm that they will respect confidentiality. Authorisations are reviewed periodically and can be withdrawn.
MDS-2	Assess access applications	This process handles an application to use microdata for a specific research project. The applicant describes the purpose, the data needed and the expected outputs. The NSI checks the legal basis, the public interest and whether the data requested is necessary. It also checks for special categories of data that need extra approval. The result is an approval with conditions, or a reasoned refusal.
MDS-3	Prepare research datasets	This process prepares the datasets for an approved project. It selects only the data that the project needs. It replaces identifiers with project-specific pseudonyms, so that data cannot be linked across projects. Where the project brings its own data, the NSI links it under the same rules. The prepared dataset is registered with its metadata and lineage.
MDS-4	Provide a secure processing environment	This process sets up the environment in which researchers work with the data. The environment prevents data from leaving without control. Access is limited to the authorised researchers of the project. Tools and computing power are provided as agreed. All activity in the environment is logged.

ID	Process	Description
MDS-5	Facilitate privacy-preserving analysis	This process supports analysis without moving the data into one place. Examples are federated analysis, where the algorithm goes to the data, and secure multi-party computation. These techniques are used when partners cannot or may not share their data. The NSI defines the trust model, the linkage method and the output rules for each setup. The process extends microdata services to data that the NSI does not hold itself.
MDS-6	Support researchers	This process helps researchers use the data and the environment correctly. It answers questions about content, metadata and methods. It explains the rules for confidentiality and output. It handles technical problems in the environment. Good support reduces errors and speeds up research.
MDS-7	Check and release output	This process checks every output before it leaves the secure environment. It applies disclosure control rules to tables, models and other results. It also checks for risks across outputs, such as differencing between similar results. Outputs that pass are released to the researcher. Outputs that fail are returned with an explanation.
MDS-8	Monitor use and compliance	This process monitors whether institutions and researchers follow the conditions of use. It reviews logs, outputs and incidents. It also tracks the use of query or disclosure budgets where these apply. Breaches lead to measures, up to withdrawal of the authorisation. The results are reported to the data owner and to supervisory authorities where required.

ID	Process	Description
MDS-9	Close projects	This process ends a research project in a controlled way. It removes the project's data and workspace. It destroys the project-specific pseudonymisation keys. It archives what must be kept for reproducibility, such as the code and the approved outputs. The closure is recorded, so that it can be shown in an audit.

E. Data space processes

A data space is a shared environment in which organisations exchange data under common rules, while each keeps control over its own data. Examples are the European data spaces for health, mobility or public administration. An NSI can take part as a data provider, as a data user, or both. Some NSIs also act as an access body that grants access to data on behalf of other data holders. That role is not covered by the SAF reference processes. The data space processes realise parts of VS-01 *Data Acquisition and Ingestion* and VS-06 *Dissemination and Service Delivery*.

ID	Process	Description
DSP-1	Join a data space	This process prepares the NSI to take part in a data space. It assesses the rules of the data space against the NSI's legal mandate and policies. It signs the participation agreement and obtains the required identity and trust credentials. It sets up the technical connection, for example through a connector. The NSI decides in advance whether it joins as provider, as user, or as both.
DSP-2	Publish data offerings	This process makes NSI data visible in the data space. It describes datasets in the data space catalogue, using agreed metadata standards. It states the conditions under which the data may be used. Only data that the NSI may share under its legal mandate is offered. The offering is kept up to date when the data or the conditions change.

ID	Process	Description
DSP-3	Agree data use conditions	This process agrees on the terms of a specific data exchange. Provider and user agree on purpose, duration, permitted use and security measures. The terms are recorded in a contract or usage policy that machines can check where possible. The NSI checks that the terms fit its confidentiality rules. Without agreed terms, no data is exchanged.
DSP-4	Exchange data under usage control	This process carries out the agreed data exchange. Data is transferred securely, or analysed where it resides without transfer. Usage control enforces the agreed conditions where the technology allows it. Every exchange is logged. Incoming data enters the NSI through the data acquisition process and is registered as raw data.
DSP-5	Monitor compliance and report	This process monitors whether the NSI's own exchanges follow the rules of the data space. It checks agreements, logs, incidents and the use of data. It reports security incidents within the legal deadlines. It also checks whether partners respect the conditions agreed for NSI data. Breaches lead to measures, including suspension of the exchange.
DSP-6	Participate in data space governance	This process covers the NSI's role in steering the data space. The NSI takes part in governance bodies and contributes to the rules and standards. It brings in statistical expertise on metadata, classifications, quality and confidentiality. It also evaluates whether participation still serves its mandate. When the NSI leaves a data space, this process arranges a controlled exit.

Toolkit (planned): Process template and process mapping

Business Functions

The concept

A **business function** is a grouping of behaviour based on the knowledge, skills and resources it needs. A function describes *what* the organisation does on a continuous basis. It has no start or end, and it does not

depend on the order in which work is done. *Manage metadata* is a function: it exists as long as the NSI exists, whatever process happens to use it. Functions are stable, because the competences an organisation needs change much more slowly than its procedures.

Functions differ from processes. A process is a sequence of activities with a trigger and a result. A function is a lasting area of competence that processes draw on. One process uses several functions, and one function serves several processes. The mapping at the end of this section shows how they relate.

Functions also differ from capabilities. A capability, in the Strategy layer, describes an *ability* the NSI has or needs. A function, in the business layer, describes the *behaviour* that delivers that ability. Functions realise capabilities. In practice, the two often have similar names, but they serve different purposes: capabilities support planning and investment, functions support the design of the organisation and its processes.

How the SAF applies business functions

Why the SAF describes business functions

Functions give a stable picture of the organisation that does not change with every reorganisation or new system. They are the natural basis for assigning responsibilities: each function has an owner who maintains the competence. They also help to compare NSIs. Two NSIs may have very different processes and departments, but they will recognise the same functions. Finally, functions make gaps visible. A function that no one owns is a competence that the organisation risks losing.

How business functions fit into an NSI's own architecture

An NSI maps its departments and teams onto the SAF functions. The mapping shows which unit carries which function, and where functions are spread over several units. An NSI can also map the SAF functions onto a national function model, such as a government-wide model for business support. Functions that are specific to the NSI's mandate are added as extensions. The SAF function areas for statistical production, data management, microdata services and data spaces are specific to official statistics. The business support area is generic and can be replaced by a national model where one exists.

Relationships with other concepts

Related concept	Relationship	Example in the SAF
Capabilities (Strategy)	Functions realise capabilities	FUN-7.2 *Manage metadata* realises Metadata management (2.1.2)
Business processes	Processes realise functions; functions are assigned to processes	PRD-5.4 *Edit and impute* uses FUN-3.3 *Process statistical data*
Business roles	Roles are assigned to functions	ROL-03 *Data steward* is assigned to FUN-7.3 *Manage data lifecycle and storage*
Business actors	Organisational units carry functions	A methodology department carries FUN-4.1
Business services	Functions realise business services	FUN-8.1 realises the microdata access service
Application services	Application services serve functions	A metadata catalogue serves FUN-7.2

Function areas

Area	Name	Scope
FUN-1	Strategy and Leadership	Direction, governance and strategic relations of the NSI
FUN-2	Capability Development	Planning, developing and maintaining the abilities of the NSI, including architecture

Area	Name	Scope
FUN-3	Statistical Production	Designing, producing and disseminating statistics
FUN-4	Methodology and Research	Statistical methods, research and innovation
FUN-5	Quality Management	The quality framework and quality assurance
FUN-6	Data Supplier Management	Relations, agreements and burden for data providers and respondents
FUN-7	Data Management	Data and metadata as managed assets across their life cycle
FUN-8	Microdata Services	Controlled access to microdata for research
FUN-9	Data Space Participation	Taking part in data spaces as provider and user
FUN-10	Business Support	The generic support functions of the organisation

PLACEHOLDER: ArchiMate view of the SAF function model

FUN-1 Strategy and Leadership

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-1	**Strategy and Leadership**	This area gives direction to the NSI. It sets the vision, the strategy and the priorities. It governs the organisation and accounts for its results. It maintains relationships with the government, the statistical community and society. All other functions work within the direction this area sets.	4.1
FUN-1.1	Define vision and strategy	This function defines the mission, vision, goals and values of the NSI. It analyses the national and international environment, including the drivers in the Motivation layer. It translates the vision into a strategy and domain strategies. It sets priorities for the product and service portfolio. The results guide investment and change for several years.	4.1.1, 4.1.2

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-1.2	Govern and steer the organisation	This function makes sure the NSI is run according to its strategy and its legal mandate. It sets up governance bodies, decision rights and the planning and control cycle. It allocates resources to programmes and departments. It monitors performance and intervenes when needed. It also accounts to the ministry, supervisory bodies and the public.	4.1.1, 4.1.5
FUN-1.3	Manage strategic collaboration	This function maintains the strategic relationships of the NSI with other organisations. It covers the national statistical system, international statistical organisations and other governments. It identifies opportunities for joint work, data exchange and shared solutions. It represents the NSI in working groups and governance bodies. It makes sure the NSI speaks with one voice.	4.1.6
FUN-1.4	Build public confidence	This function builds and protects public trust in official statistics. It explains the role and independence of the NSI to the public. It promotes the value of statistics and of providing data to the NSI. It responds to misuse or misinterpretation of statistics. Trust is the basis for both response and use, so this function supports the whole chain.	1.5.2, 4.1.5

FUN-2 Capability Development

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-2	**Capability Development**	This area develops and improves the abilities of the NSI. It plans improvements, carries them out and checks whether they deliver. It covers methods, processes, data, systems and skills. It also maintains the enterprise architecture that keeps improvements coherent. This area turns the strategy into concrete change.	4.1.3, 4.1.4
FUN-2.1	Plan capability improvements	This function identifies which capabilities need to improve and in which order. It uses capability assessments, evaluations and strategic priorities. It proposes programmes and projects with a business case. It coordinates the plans across the organisation to avoid overlap. The result is a prioritised portfolio of improvements.	4.1.3
FUN-2.2	Develop capability improvements	This function carries out approved improvements. It specifies, designs, builds and tests the change. It follows the architecture principles and reuses existing solutions where possible. It involves the people who will use the result. The function ends when the improvement is ready to be taken into use.	4.1.3, 3.2.1

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-2.3	Monitor capabilities	This function checks whether capabilities perform as intended. It measures maturity and the benefits of past investments. It identifies capabilities that are declining or no longer needed. It reports to management and feeds the next planning round. Without monitoring, investments cannot be shown to pay off.	4.1.4
FUN-2.4	Transfer capability improvements to operations	This function hands over a finished improvement to the teams that will run and support it. It arranges documentation, training and support agreements. It checks that the operating teams are ready before the handover. It closes the project or programme. A clean transfer prevents improvements from falling back into project mode.	3.2.2
FUN-2.5	Manage enterprise architecture	This function develops and maintains the enterprise architecture of the NSI. It uses the SAF as its reference. It advises on strategy, investments and projects, and reviews them against the architecture principles. It supports the architecture board and keeps the architecture repository up to date. It keeps the NSI architecture aligned with the SAF as both evolve.	

FUN-3 Statistical Production

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-3	**Statistical Production**	This area produces official statistics, from the first design to the release. It is the core of the NSI's mandate. The statistical production processes (PRD) realise this area. Its functions follow the main kinds of statistical work: design, collection, processing, estimation, confidentiality and dissemination. Each function brings together the specialist knowledge for that kind of work.	1
FUN-3.1	Design and build statistical products	This function designs statistical products and the processes that produce them. It translates information needs into outputs, variables, methods and workflows. It also builds and tests the production solution. It works closely with methodology and with the users of the product. The function owns the design of each product over its life cycle.	1.1
FUN-3.2	Collect and acquire data	This function obtains the data that statistical products need. It runs surveys, receives administrative data and acquires data from other sources, including data spaces. It makes sure that data arrives complete, on time and under the right agreements. It keeps respondent burden as low as possible. The function delivers data into the first steady state.	1.2

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-3.3	Process statistical data	This function turns raw data into reliable microdata. It integrates, standardises, codes, validates, edits and imputes data. It also derives new variables and units. It applies the methods designed for each product. The function produces standardised and processed microdata.	1.3.1, 1.3.2, 1.3.3, 1.3.4
FUN-3.4	Estimate and analyse	This function produces statistics from microdata and checks that they are sound. It calculates weights, estimates and aggregates. It integrates statistics into consistent wholes, such as the national accounts. It validates and interprets the results. The function produces the statistics that are ready for release.	1.3.5, 1.3.6, 1.4
FUN-3.5	Protect statistical confidentiality	This function makes sure that no output reveals information about individual respondents. It sets the confidentiality rules and the methods for disclosure control. It applies them to tables, microdata files and services. It assesses disclosure risks in new types of output. The function works across all products and channels.	1.3.7
FUN-3.6	Disseminate statistics	This function brings statistics to users. It manages the release calendar, the publication channels and the products. It makes sure that all users get access at the same moment. It also supports users in finding and understanding the statistics. The function produces released data.	1.5

FUN-4 Methodology and Research

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-4	**Methodology and Research**	This area provides the scientific basis for statistical production. It develops and maintains statistical methods. It explores new data sources, new techniques and new products. It makes sure that innovations are sound before they enter production. This area protects the methodological quality that makes official statistics credible.	2.2
FUN-4.1	Manage statistical and analytical methodology	This function develops, documents and maintains the methods used in production. It covers sampling, collection, editing, imputation, estimation, disclosure control and analysis. It includes methods based on machine learning and AI. It advises production teams and reviews their methods. Methods are standardised and shared across products where possible.	2.2.3
FUN-4.2	Research and innovate	This function explores new possibilities for statistics. It investigates new data sources and new ways to use existing data. It develops prototypes of new products and methods. It evaluates whether innovations are feasible and sound. Successful innovations are handed over to production through capability development.	2.2.1, 2.2.2

FUN-5 Quality Management

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-5	**Quality Management**	This area makes sure that the NSI delivers statistics of the required quality. It maintains the quality framework and the tools to apply it. It assures quality in products and processes. It prepares the NSI for reviews and audits. This area is the corporate counterpart of the quality management process in production.	2.1.3
FUN-5.1	Manage the quality framework	This function sets the quality standards of the NSI. It defines quality dimensions, indicators and reporting requirements. It aligns the framework with international standards, such as the European Statistics Code of Practice. It provides tools and guidance to production teams. The framework is reviewed and improved regularly.	2.1.3
FUN-5.2	Assure and review quality	This function checks whether products and processes meet the quality standards. It monitors quality indicators and reviews quality reports. It carries out quality reviews and self-assessments. It follows up on findings with improvement actions. It also supports external reviews, such as peer reviews.	2.1.3, 4.1.5

FUN-6 Data Supplier Management

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-6	**Data Supplier Management**	This area manages the relationships with everyone who supplies data to the NSI. It covers respondents, administrative data holders and other data providers. It sets up and maintains agreements. It monitors the burden that the NSI places on suppliers. Good supplier management improves both the quality of data and the willingness to provide it.	3.4
FUN-6.1	Manage data supplier relationships	This function maintains contact with data providers and respondent groups. It explains why the NSI needs the data and how it is used. It handles questions, complaints and feedback on data quality. It coordinates all contacts, so that a supplier deals with one NSI and not with many departments. The function builds long-term cooperation.	3.4.2
FUN-6.2	Manage data provision agreements	This function draws up, maintains and enforces agreements with data providers. Agreements cover content, format, timing, quality, security and legal basis. The function keeps a register of all agreements. It renews or adjusts agreements when sources or needs change. It also handles enforcement when obligations are not met.	3.4.3

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-6.3	Manage response burden	This function measures and limits the burden of statistical data collection. It tracks how much time and effort respondents and data providers spend. It looks for ways to reduce burden, such as reusing existing data. It coordinates surveys so that the same units are not approached too often. It reports on burden to management and government.	1.2, 2.2.5

FUN-7 Data Management

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-7	**Data Management**	This area manages data and metadata as assets of the NSI. It covers governance, metadata, the data life cycle, reference data and data protection. It works across all statistical products and domains. It makes sure that data can be found, understood, trusted and reused. The data lifecycle management processes (DLM) realise this area.	2.1
FUN-7.1	Govern data	This function sets the rules for data management in the NSI. It defines data policies, standards and responsibilities. It assigns data owners, data stewards and data custodians. It resolves issues that cross domain boundaries. It monitors compliance with the data policies.	2.1.1, 4.1.2

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-7.2	Manage metadata	This function captures, maintains and publishes metadata. Metadata describes concepts, variables, classifications, datasets, methods and processes. The function maintains the catalogue in which data can be found. It makes sure that metadata is captured when data is created. It applies international standards, such as GSIM and SDMX.	2.1.2
FUN-7.3	Manage data lifecycle and storage	This function manages data from creation to disposal. It covers quality gates, registration, versioning, storage, retention and disposal. It keeps track of lineage, from output back to source. It makes sure that earlier versions remain available when they are needed. The function applies the design rules of the steady-state model.	2.1.1
FUN-7.4	Manage reference and master data	This function manages the data that other data depends on. Examples are classifications, code lists, statistical registers and population frames. It controls versions and announces changes in advance. It makes sure that all domains use the same version. The function is the single source of truth for reference data.	2.1.4

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-7.5	Protect data	This function protects data according to its classification. It applies measures for availability, integrity and confidentiality. It manages pseudonymisation and the keys used for it. It keeps keys separate from the data they protect. The function works closely with information security and privacy management.	3.3.1, 3.3.4

FUN-8 Microdata Services

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-8	**Microdata Services**	This area gives researchers controlled access to microdata. It covers authorisation, data preparation, secure environments and output control. It also supports analysis without moving data, using privacy-preserving techniques. The NSI remains responsible for confidentiality throughout. The microdata services processes (MDS) realise this area.	2.2.4
FUN-8.1	Manage research access	This function decides who may use microdata, for which purpose and under which conditions. It authorises institutions and researchers. It assesses applications for research projects. It monitors whether users keep to the conditions. It withdraws access when rules are broken.	2.2.4, 3.4.3

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-8.2	Prepare research data	This function prepares the datasets for each approved project. It selects only the data that the project needs. It applies project-specific pseudonyms, so that data cannot be linked across projects. It links data that researchers bring in, under the same rules. It documents the prepared data with metadata and lineage.	2.2.4, 3.3.1
FUN-8.3	Operate secure research environments	This function provides and runs the environments in which researchers work. It controls who may enter and what may leave. It provides tools and computing power. It logs all activity. It removes data and workspaces when projects end.	2.2.4, 3.2.5
FUN-8.4	Control research output	This function checks all results before they leave the secure environment. It applies disclosure control rules to tables, models and other output. It checks for risks across outputs, such as differencing between similar results. It keeps a record of every release. The function protects respondents while allowing research to proceed.	1.3.7

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-8.5	Enable privacy-preserving analysis	This function makes analysis possible without bringing all data together. It uses techniques such as federated analysis and secure multi-party computation. It defines the trust model, the linkage method and the output rules for each setup. It works with partners who cannot or may not share their data. The function extends microdata services beyond the data the NSI holds itself.	2.2.4, 2.2.3

FUN-9 Data Space Participation

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-9	**Data Space Participation**	This area enables the NSI to take part in data spaces. The NSI can act as a data provider, as a data user, or both. The area covers agreements, technical connection and governance. It makes sure that participation fits the NSI's legal mandate and confidentiality rules. The data space processes (DSP) realise this area.	4.1.6, 3.4
FUN-9.1	Manage data space participation	This function decides in which data spaces the NSI takes part, and in which role. It assesses the rules of each data space against the NSI's mandate. It manages participation agreements, data offerings and usage conditions. It monitors whether exchanges follow the agreed rules. It reviews participation regularly.	4.1.6, 3.4.3

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-9.2	Operate data space connectivity	This function provides the technical connection to data spaces. It runs the connectors, identity credentials and catalogue entries. It carries out data exchanges under the agreed usage conditions. It logs every exchange. Incoming data is passed on to data collection and enters the first steady state.	3.4.1, 3.2.5
FUN-9.3	Contribute to data space governance	This function represents the NSI in the governance of data spaces. It contributes to rules, standards and rulebooks. It brings in statistical expertise on metadata, classifications, quality and confidentiality. It aligns positions with other NSIs where possible. It also arranges a controlled exit when participation ends.	4.1.6

FUN-10 Business Support

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-10	**Business Support**	This area provides the people, money, information, technology and facilities that the other functions need. Its functions are similar in every public organisation. The SAF describes them only at a high level. An NSI can replace this area with the function model of its own government. The functions are still part of the SAF, because statistical work depends on them.	3

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-10.1	Manage human resources	This function makes sure the NSI has enough qualified staff. It covers recruitment, development, performance and the departure of staff. It plans the skills the NSI will need in the future. It supports managers in leading their teams. Skills such as data science and methodology are scarce, which makes this function critical.	3.1.1
FUN-10.2	Manage finance and procurement	This function manages the budget, the accounts and the purchase of goods and services. It plans and controls spending. It runs procurement procedures and manages supplier contracts. It reports on the financial position to management and government. It makes sure that spending follows the rules for public money.	3.1.2, 3.1.3
FUN-10.3	Manage information technology	This function provides and manages the IT the NSI needs. It covers applications, platforms, infrastructure and the digital workplace. It develops, configures and maintains systems. It runs IT services and resolves disruptions. It plans the evolution of the technical landscape.	3.2
FUN-10.4	Manage information and records	This function manages the information created in management and support processes. It keeps records according to archives legislation. It makes information findable and accessible over time. It also manages the knowledge base of the organisation. Statistical data itself is managed by FUN-7 *Data Management*.	3.1.8

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-10.5	Manage legal affairs	This function provides legal advice and support. It interprets the statistics law, data protection law and other rules. It assesses agreements and contracts. It handles legal procedures and objections. It keeps the overview of legal obligations, for example in a legal register.	3.1.7
FUN-10.6	Manage communication	This function manages internal and external communication. It covers press relations, the website, social media and internal information. It makes sure the NSI communicates clearly and consistently. It supports the release of statistics with press releases and explanations. It also handles questions from the media.	3.1.4
FUN-10.7	Manage facilities	This function provides the buildings, workplaces and physical services the NSI needs. It covers housing, maintenance, catering and physical access. It makes sure that buildings and spaces are safe. It supports field staff with the means they need. It plans facilities in line with ways of working, such as hybrid work.	3.1.6, 3.3.5
FUN-10.8	Manage information security and privacy	This function protects the NSI's information and the privacy of the people it concerns. It sets security and privacy policies and monitors compliance. It manages incidents and leads recovery. It assesses risks in new solutions and suppliers. It includes the role of the data protection officer.	3.3

ID	Function	Description	Capabilities
FUN-10.9	Manage users and services	This function manages the relationship with the users of statistics. It identifies user groups and their needs. It manages the portfolio of products and services and their service levels. It handles questions, requests and complaints. It measures user satisfaction and passes feedback on to production.	3.4.1, 3.4.2, 2.2.5

Process and function mapping

The table shows which functions each process uses. The *main function* carries the knowledge the process mainly depends on. *Supporting functions* contribute specific expertise or resources. In ArchiMate, the process realises part of the main function, and the supporting functions are related through assignment or serving relationships.

PLACEHOLDER: ArchiMate view of the process and function mapping

A. Statistical production processes

Process	Name	Main function	Supporting functions
PRD-1	**Specify Needs**	FUN-3.1	FUN-10.9
PRD-1.1	Identify needs	FUN-3.1	FUN-10.9
PRD-1.2	Consult and confirm needs	FUN-3.1	FUN-10.9
PRD-1.3	Establish output objectives	FUN-3.1	FUN-5.1
PRD-1.4	Identify concepts	FUN-3.1	FUN-4.1
PRD-1.5	Check data availability and suitability	FUN-3.1	FUN-6.1, FUN-7.2
PRD-1.6	Prepare and submit business case	FUN-3.1	FUN-1.2, FUN-2.1
PRD-2	**Design**	FUN-3.1	FUN-4.1
PRD-2.1	Design outputs and dissemination	FUN-3.1	FUN-3.5, FUN-3.6
PRD-2.2	Design variables	FUN-3.1	FUN-7.2, FUN-7.4
PRD-2.3	Design collection	FUN-3.1	FUN-3.2, FUN-6.1
PRD-2.4	Design frame and sample	FUN-3.1	FUN-4.1, FUN-7.4
PRD-2.5	Design processing and analysis	FUN-4.1	FUN-3.1, FUN-3.5
PRD-2.6	Design production systems and workflows	FUN-3.1	FUN-2.5, FUN-10.3
PRD-3	**Build**	FUN-3.1	FUN-10.3
PRD-3.1	Reuse or build collection instruments	FUN-3.1	FUN-3.2

Process	Name	Main function	Supporting functions
PRD-3.2	Reuse or build processing and analysis components	FUN-3.1	FUN-4.1, FUN-10.3
PRD-3.3	Reuse or build dissemination components	FUN-3.1	FUN-3.6, FUN-10.3
PRD-3.4	Configure workflows	FUN-3.1	FUN-7.3, FUN-10.3
PRD-3.5	Test production systems	FUN-3.1	FUN-10.3
PRD-3.6	Test statistical business process	FUN-3.1	FUN-5.2
PRD-3.7	Finalise production systems	FUN-3.1	FUN-2.4, FUN-7.2
PRD-4	**Collect**	FUN-3.2	FUN-6.1
PRD-4.1	Create frame and select sample	FUN-3.2	FUN-4.1, FUN-7.4
PRD-4.2	Set up collection	FUN-3.2	FUN-6.2
PRD-4.3	Run collection	FUN-3.2	FUN-6.1, FUN-6.3
PRD-4.4	Finalise collection	FUN-3.2	FUN-7.3
PRD-5	**Process**	FUN-3.3	FUN-3.4
PRD-5.1	Integrate data	FUN-3.3	FUN-7.4, FUN-7.5
PRD-5.2	Classify and code	FUN-3.3	FUN-7.4
PRD-5.3	Review and validate	FUN-3.3	FUN-5.2
PRD-5.4	Edit and impute	FUN-3.3	FUN-4.1
PRD-5.5	Derive new variables and units	FUN-3.3	FUN-7.2
PRD-5.6	Calculate weights	FUN-3.4	FUN-4.1
PRD-5.7	Calculate aggregates	FUN-3.4	FUN-4.1
PRD-5.8	Finalise data files	FUN-3.3	FUN-7.3
PRD-6	**Analyse**	FUN-3.4	FUN-3.5
PRD-6.1	Prepare draft outputs	FUN-3.4	FUN-3.6
PRD-6.2	Validate outputs	FUN-3.4	FUN-5.2
PRD-6.3	Interpret and explain outputs	FUN-3.4	FUN-10.6
PRD-6.4	Apply disclosure control	FUN-3.5	FUN-4.1
PRD-6.5	Finalise outputs	FUN-3.4	FUN-5.2
PRD-7	**Disseminate**	FUN-3.6	FUN-10.9
PRD-7.1	Update output systems	FUN-3.6	FUN-10.3
PRD-7.2	Produce dissemination products	FUN-3.6	FUN-10.6
PRD-7.3	Release dissemination products	FUN-3.6	FUN-1.4
PRD-7.4	Promote dissemination products	FUN-3.6	FUN-10.6, FUN-1.4
PRD-7.5	Provide user support	FUN-10.9	FUN-3.6
PRD-8	**Evaluate**	FUN-5.2	FUN-2.3
PRD-8.1	Gather evaluation inputs	FUN-5.2	FUN-7.3
PRD-8.2	Conduct evaluation	FUN-5.2	FUN-2.3
PRD-8.3	Agree an action plan	FUN-2.1	FUN-5.2

B. Overarching processes

Process	Name	Main function	Supporting functions
OVA-1	Quality Management	FUN-5.2	FUN-5.1
OVA-2	Metadata Management	FUN-7.2	FUN-7.4

Process	Name	Main function	Supporting functions
OVA-3	Data Management	FUN-7.3	FUN-7.1
OVA-4	Process Data Management	FUN-7.3	FUN-5.2
OVA-5	Knowledge Management	FUN-10.4	FUN-4.1
OVA-6	Data Supplier Management	FUN-6.1	FUN-6.3

C. Data lifecycle management processes

Process	Name	Main function	Supporting functions
DLM-1	Plan and design data assets	FUN-7.1	FUN-2.5
DLM-2	Promote data through a quality gate	FUN-7.3	FUN-5.2
DLM-3	Register and catalogue data	FUN-7.2	FUN-7.3
DLM-4	Classify and protect data	FUN-7.5	FUN-10.8
DLM-5	Store and version data	FUN-7.3	FUN-10.3
DLM-6	Provide data for reuse	FUN-7.1	FUN-7.3
DLM-7	Revise data	FUN-7.3	FUN-7.2
DLM-8	Monitor data quality, lineage and use	FUN-7.1	FUN-5.2
DLM-9	Manage reference and master data	FUN-7.4	FUN-7.2
DLM-10	Archive and preserve data	FUN-10.4	FUN-7.3
DLM-11	Dispose of data	FUN-7.3	FUN-7.5

D. Microdata services processes

Process	Name	Main function	Supporting functions
MDS-1	Authorise institutions and researchers	FUN-8.1	FUN-10.5
MDS-2	Assess access applications	FUN-8.1	FUN-10.5, FUN-7.1
MDS-3	Prepare research datasets	FUN-8.2	FUN-7.5
MDS-4	Provide a secure processing environment	FUN-8.3	FUN-10.3, FUN-10.8
MDS-5	Facilitate privacy-preserving analysis	FUN-8.5	FUN-4.1, FUN-7.5
MDS-6	Support researchers	FUN-8.3	FUN-10.9
MDS-7	Check and release output	FUN-8.4	FUN-3.5
MDS-8	Monitor use and compliance	FUN-8.1	FUN-10.8
MDS-9	Close projects	FUN-8.3	FUN-7.3, FUN-7.5

E. Data space processes

Process	Name	Main function	Supporting functions
DSP-1	Join a data space	FUN-9.1	FUN-10.5, FUN-10.8
DSP-2	Publish data offerings	FUN-9.1	FUN-7.2
DSP-3	Agree data use conditions	FUN-9.1	FUN-10.5
DSP-4	Exchange data under usage control	FUN-9.2	FUN-3.2, FUN-7.3
DSP-5	Monitor compliance and report	FUN-9.1	FUN-10.8

Process	Name	Main function	Supporting functions
DSP-6	Participate in data space governance	FUN-9.3	FUN-1.3

Functions without a reference process

Six functions are not used by any SAF reference process. They are carried out through management, change or support processes that are specific to each NSI. Many other functions appear only as supporting functions, which is normal for strategic and support functions.

Function	Carried out through
FUN-1.1 Define vision and strategy	The strategic planning cycle of the NSI
FUN-2.2 Develop capability improvements	Change programmes and projects
FUN-4.2 Research and innovate	Innovation projects (see VS-08)
FUN-10.1 Manage human resources	Generic business support processes
FUN-10.2 Manage finance and procurement	Generic business support processes
FUN-10.7 Manage facilities	Generic business support processes

Mapping to value stream stages

The mapping connects the Strategy layer to the business layer. A value stream stage describes the value that is added. The processes describe the work that adds it. The functions describe the competences that the work depends on.

PLACEHOLDER: ArchiMate view of value stream stages, processes and functions

Primary value streams

Stage	Name	Realised by processes	Main functions
VS-01.1	Identify Data Needs and Sources	PRD-1.1, PRD-1.5, PRD-2.3	FUN-3.1, FUN-6.1
VS-01.2	Establish Data Agreements and Access Rights	OVA-6, DSP-1, DSP-3	FUN-6.2, FUN-9.1, FUN-10.5
VS-01.3	Collect or Receive Data	PRD-4.1, PRD-4.2, PRD-4.3, DSP-4	FUN-3.2, FUN-9.2
VS-01.4	Validate and Log Data Intake	PRD-4.4, DLM-2	FUN-3.2, FUN-7.3
VS-01.5	Store and Register Raw Data Artefacts	DLM-3, DLM-4, DLM-5	FUN-7.2, FUN-7.3, FUN-7.5
VS-02.1	Profile and Assess Data Structure	PRD-5.3	FUN-3.3
VS-02.2	Apply Standard Classifications and Formats	PRD-5.2, DLM-9	FUN-3.3, FUN-7.4
VS-02.3	Align Metadata and Semantics	OVA-2	FUN-7.2
VS-02.4	Validate Structural and Semantic Conformance	PRD-5.3, DLM-2	FUN-3.3, FUN-7.3
VS-02.5	Register Standardized Artefacts	DLM-3, DLM-4, DLM-5	FUN-7.2, FUN-7.3, FUN-7.5

Stage	Name	Realised by processes	Main functions
VS-03.1	Conduct Error Detection and Quality Diagnostics	PRD-5.3	FUN-3.3
VS-03.2	Perform Data Editing and Correction	PRD-5.2, PRD-5.4	FUN-3.3
VS-03.3	Impute Missing or Non-Response Data	PRD-5.4	FUN-3.3, FUN-4.1
VS-03.4	Derive Additional Variables and Indicators	PRD-5.1, PRD-5.5	FUN-3.3
VS-03.5	Perform Quality Evaluation and Versioning	PRD-5.8, DLM-2, DLM-3	FUN-3.3, FUN-5.2, FUN-7.3
VS-04.1	Confirm Estimation and Analytical Approach	PRD-2.4, PRD-2.5	FUN-3.1, FUN-4.1
VS-04.2	Apply Weighting and Calibration	PRD-5.6	FUN-3.4
VS-04.3	Estimate and Aggregate Data	PRD-5.7	FUN-3.4
VS-04.4	Perform Model-Based Analysis	PRD-6.1, PRD-6.3	FUN-3.4
VS-04.5	Validate and Document Results	PRD-6.2, PRD-6.4, OVA-2	FUN-3.4, FUN-3.5, FUN-7.2
VS-05.1	Select and Integrate Source Datasets	PRD-5.1, PRD-6.1	FUN-3.4
VS-05.2	Construct Composite Indicators or Indices	PRD-5.5, PRD-5.7	FUN-3.3, FUN-3.4
VS-05.3	Perform Consistency and Coherence Checks	PRD-6.2	FUN-3.4, FUN-5.2
VS-05.4	Generate Analytical and Interpretive Outputs	PRD-6.3, PRD-7.2	FUN-3.4, FUN-3.6
VS-05.5	Approve and Register Statistical Products	PRD-6.4, PRD-6.5, DLM-3	FUN-3.4, FUN-3.5, FUN-7.2
VS-06.1	Plan Dissemination and Access Strategy	PRD-2.1	FUN-3.1, FUN-3.6
VS-06.2	Prepare Data for Dissemination	PRD-6.4, PRD-7.1	FUN-3.5, FUN-3.6
VS-06.3	Publish and Provide Access Services	PRD-7.2, PRD-7.3, MDS-1 to MDS-5, MDS-7, DSP-2	FUN-3.6, FUN-8.1 to FUN-8.5, FUN-9.1
VS-06.4	Support and Engage Users	PRD-7.4, PRD-7.5, MDS-6	FUN-3.6, FUN-8.3, FUN-10.9
VS-06.5	Monitor Usage and Feedback	PRD-8.1, MDS-8, MDS-9	FUN-8.1, FUN-8.3, FUN-10.9

Supporting value streams

Stage	Name	Realised by processes	Main functions
VS-07.1	Define Governance Frameworks and Policies	DLM-1	FUN-1.2, FUN-5.1, FUN-7.1
VS-07.2	Establish Legal and Regulatory Compliance Mechanisms	DLM-4	FUN-10.5, FUN-10.8
VS-07.3	Implement Data and Metadata Governance	OVA-2, OVA-3, DLM-1, DLM-6	FUN-7.1, FUN-7.2

Stage	Name	Realised by processes	Main functions
VS-07.4	Monitor Quality and Compliance Indicators	OVA-1, DLM-8, MDS-8, DSP-5	FUN-5.2, FUN-7.1
VS-07.5	Audit, Certify and Report Compliance	OVA-1, PRD-8.2	FUN-1.2, FUN-5.2
VS-07.6	Update and Improve Governance Mechanisms	PRD-8.3, DLM-10, DLM-11	FUN-2.1, FUN-7.1
VS-08.1	Identify Innovation Needs and Opportunities	PRD-1.5	FUN-4.2
VS-08.2	Conduct Research and Proof-of-Concepts	No reference process (NSI-specific)	FUN-4.2
VS-08.3	Evaluate Methodological Soundness and Feasibility	PRD-3.6	FUN-4.1, FUN-5.2
VS-08.4	Develop and Document New Methodologies or Tools	PRD-3.2, OVA-5	FUN-4.1, FUN-10.4
VS-08.5	Integrate Innovation into Production Environments	PRD-3.7	FUN-2.4, FUN-3.1
VS-08.6	Promote Knowledge Sharing and Capability Building	OVA-5	FUN-10.1, FUN-10.4
VS-09.1	Define Digital and Technical Requirements	PRD-2.6	FUN-2.5, FUN-3.1
VS-09.2	Design Platform and Infrastructure Architecture	PRD-2.6	FUN-2.5, FUN-10.3
VS-09.3	Provision and Configure Platforms	PRD-3.4, MDS-4	FUN-8.3, FUN-10.3
VS-09.4	Enable Integration and Orchestration Services	PRD-3.4, DSP-4	FUN-9.2, FUN-10.3
VS-09.5	Ensure Performance, Security and Continuity	PRD-3.5, DLM-5	FUN-10.3, FUN-10.8
VS-09.6	Evolve and Modernise the Technical Ecosystem	No reference process (NSI-specific)	FUN-2.2, FUN-10.3
VS-10.1	Identify and Segment Stakeholders	PRD-1.2, DSP-6	FUN-1.3, FUN-10.9
VS-10.2	Collect and Analyse User Needs	PRD-1.1, PRD-1.2	FUN-3.1, FUN-10.9
VS-10.3	Define and Manage Service Portfolios	PRD-2.1	FUN-10.9
VS-10.4	Deliver Services and Manage Relationships	PRD-7.5, MDS-6, OVA-6	FUN-6.1, FUN-10.9
VS-10.5	Engage and Communicate with Stakeholders	PRD-7.4	FUN-1.4, FUN-10.6
VS-10.6	Monitor Impact and Satisfaction	PRD-8.1, PRD-8.2	FUN-5.2, FUN-10.9

Toolkit (planned): Function template and organisation-to-function mapping

Business Services, Events and Objects

The sections on business services and interfaces, business events, and business objects, contracts, representations and products are planned for a later version. Until then, the services, events and objects of each value stream are described in attribute 8 of the Statistical Data Value Chain chapter, and the objects handed over between value streams in the Steady-State Architecture.

PLACEHOLDER: Business Services and Business Interfaces; Business Events; Business Objects, Contracts, Representations and Products

Reference Models for the Statistical Data Value Chain

Why the SAF offers more than one model NSIs differ in size, mandate, legal context, data volumes, and technology platform. A single prescribed arrangement would fit some offices well and others poorly. The SAF therefore describes reference models: alternative, internally consistent ways of organising the value chain. Each model answers the same four questions:

1. At which points is data persisted and made available for reuse?
2. Which quality criteria must data meet at each point?
3. Who is accountable for the data at each point?
4. How are confidentiality and traceability guaranteed along the chain?

The SAF currently describes two reference models. Both follow the same underlying idea, progressive improvement of data through defined layers, but they differ in granularity and in where they place governance.

Model A: Steady-State Architecture

The Steady-State Architecture organises the value chain into business domains that are loosely coupled through five numbered steady states (#1 Raw, #2 Standardized, #3 Processed, #4 Statistics, #5 Released). Each state represents a specific kind of statistical value and has its own quality gate, ownership, and handover interface. The model is derived from production practice in NSIs with many statistical domains and extensive microdata reuse. It is described in full in the remainder of this chapter.

Model B: Medallion Architecture

The Medallion Architecture organises data into three layers of increasing quality, usually called Bronze (raw), Silver (cleansed and conformed), and Gold (curated for consumption). The pattern originates from lakehouse platforms and is a logical design pattern rather than a product. Its strength lays in its simplicity. There are three layers, a clear direction of flow, and the ability to rebuild any layer from the one below it.

As a data-engineering pattern, Medallion does not by itself define statistical semantics, accountability, or confidentiality rules per layer.

Comparison

Characteristic	Steady-State Architecture	Medallion Architecture
Number of governed handover points	Five (#1 to #5)	Three (Bronze, Silver, Gold)
Origin	Statistical production practice	Lakehouse data engineering
Granularity of quality gates	Fine: one gate per kind of statistical value	Coarse: several kinds of value combined per layer
Separation of standardisation and editing	Explicit (#2 vs. #3)	Combined in Silver
Separation of internal statistics and released data	Explicit (#4 vs. #5)	Combined in Gold unless subdivided
Governance overhead	Higher: more states to own, register, and audit	Lower

Characteristic	Steady-State Architecture	Medallion Architecture
Fit with platform tooling	Platform-neutral; mapping required	Native in lakehouse platforms
Typical adopters	Larger NSIs, many domains, high microdata reuse	Smaller NSIs, platform-led modernisation

Selection criteria

The criteria below help an NSI decide which model fits best. They are indicative. No single criterion is decisive, and the SAF toolkit will provide a structured assessment.

Criterion	Points towards Steady-State	Points towards Medallion
Organisational size and number of statistical domains	Many domains, many teams handing over data	Few domains, small central data team
Reuse of intermediate microdata across domains	High; standardised and processed microdata reused by several products	Limited; most data flows within one product chain
Legal requirements on pseudonymisation timing	Law or policy requires a separate, auditable pseudonymisation point	Pseudonymisation can be applied at the Silver boundary
Archival and reproducibility obligations	Specific states (e.g., processed microdata) must be retained long term	Retention can be defined per layer
Separation of internal statistics from released data	Required (embargo, different confidentiality thresholds per use)	Achievable by subdividing Gold
Metadata and governance maturity	Mature data ownership and catalogue practices in place	Governance capacity is limited and must stay lean
Technology platform	Heterogeneous landscape, on-premises and private cloud	Single lakehouse platform
Participation in international data exchange	Many handover points to external partners	Exchange concentrated on final outputs

Practice within the SAF community indicates that smaller NSIs often adopt a Medallion arrangement, while larger NSIs with many domains tend towards finer-grained states. This observation is to be substantiated through the SAF toolkit assessments.

Combining the models

The models are not mutually exclusive. The steady states can be mapped onto Medallion layers, which allows an NSI to use Medallion as its platform convention while governing data through steady states, or to start with Medallion and introduce finer states as it grows.

Steady state	Medallion layer	Note
#1 Raw Data	Bronze	Direct correspondence
#2 Standardized Data	Silver (lower sub-layer)	In Medallion often merged with #3
#3 Processed Data	Silver	Main reusable microdata layer
#4 Statistics	Gold (internal sub-layer)	Not yet released
#5 Released Data	Gold (published sub-layer)	Released after final disclosure control
#6 Data Products	Gold (consumption product sub-layer)	Packaged for consumption